

Chapter 50-1

Liang Shi had no intention of questioning her at all, and her tone was even calm without any waves.

She was simply making an inquiry.

If it were Liang Wanwan being treated this way, would Qiu Zimin feel heartbroken? Would she be sad?

She certainly would.

But why, when it came to the original host, did Qiu Zimin have to go to such extremes?

Why did she have to use such cruel methods to treat a child?

From Qi Mama¹ to the sacrifice, every single incident had gone through Qiu Zimin's hands.

Qiu Zimin was even the primary instigator.

At this moment, Liang Shi felt heartbroken for the original host and felt it was unfair to her.

Perhaps when she was very young, she had also believed in Qiu Zimin, believed in this person called mother.

Perhaps she thought that as long as she was obedient, things would get better, but she never expected that obedience was just the first step pushing her into the abyss.

The original host's unpredictable personality was inseparable from Qiu Zimin's influence.

Even if Liang Shi hadn't transmigrated over, the original host might have become insane under Qiu Zimin's torment.

In the villa corridor with no one walking around, late at night in solitude, Liang Shi quietly looked at Qiu Zimin, but her hand gripped the railing tightly.

Not for any other reason, but because she was afraid Qiu Zimin might become desperate and directly push her down from upstairs.

This was purely for self-protection.

Unexpectedly, Qiu Zimin said: "What are you talking about? You and Wanwan are both my daughters. I could only treat Wanwan badly, but I've never treated you badly. Are you sleep-walking in the middle of the night?"

"Treating me well?" Liang Shi was genuinely surprised. How could she say these three words without any guilt?

"Do you still remember my previous room?" Liang Shi said: "Why did you change the things in my room?"

"You liked your original room?" Qiu Zimin asked.

Liang Shi sneered coldly, "Do you like coffins?"

Upon hearing this, Qiu Zimin's expression immediately changed, "How are you talking? How is that a coffin! Back then, it was because your health wasn't good that I went through great efforts to find someone to read your feng shui² and change the layout. Where did you hear such gossip?"

"I heard everything you said just now." Liang Shi lowered her eyes and smiled bitterly. In the end, she was still too impulsive, but it was also good to have everything out in the open like this. "You were talking to that person on Yunfeng Mountain, weren't you? When you took me to Yunfeng Mountain back then, what was it for? I'm afraid only you know clearly."

Liang Shi acted half-truthfully, "All these years, I've been a puppet in your hands. You hid from the family and turned my room into that ghostly appearance, making me live in a coffin room. I never had a good night's sleep. Are you very happy? I never understood why you treated me this way. Now I understand—because I'm not your daughter. You would never treat Wanwan like this."

Liang Shi had no memories related to parents.

She only had a pair of grandparents who loved her. When it rained, grandfather would go to the school gate to pick her up, and grandmother would cook ginger sugar water for her at home.

She had worn sweaters that grandmother knitted for her, and rode on grandfather's back to cross rivers.

Although she had never experienced parental love, she had her grandparents' love.

But what about the original host?

The original host had nothing.

She was surrounded by wolves, and had never truly experienced what love was.

Yet Qiu Zimin still shamelessly claimed that she treated the original host the best.

Was this being good? Was this love?

No.

It was just mental torture carried out under the guise of "love."

Moreover, the system had said that Liang Shi had been to this world before.

Although it didn't say when she came, Liang Shi guessed it was before age eight. Combined with her deep-rooted fear of Qi Mama, it was very likely that she had also suffered Qiu Zimin's abuse in her childhood.

After hearing such words, it was indeed difficult to remain calm.

Qiu Zimin originally wanted to keep pretending, but after hearing Liang Shi's words, she was too lazy to pretend anymore.

She sneered coldly, "So what? What do you want to do? Liang Shi, do you think your wings have grown hard enough to challenge me?"

"How could that be." Liang Shi smiled lightly, saying as if clouds were light and wind was gentle: "I just want to become a normal person."

"Normal person? How are you not normal?" Qiu Zimin said: "I give you money, food, clothing, let you be willful, more pampered than anyone around you, you can do whatever you want. Liang Shi, have you been living the good life for too long?"

Liang Shi didn't answer her words, just quietly stared at her.

And Qiu Zimin sneered: "Liang Shi, with your useless appearance, you can't accomplish anything if you leave the Liang family."

"Is that so?" Liang Shi said confidently: "Then let's wait and see."

"After you finish paying last month's credit card bill with the money you have on hand, you'll have nothing left, right?" Qiu Zimin had a superior attitude, "If you continue to listen to me and obediently be my daughter, I'll still treat you as well as before. You should know that in this circle, you're the most pampered."

Even at this point, she was still using both kindness and 威³.

"You should know that you have neither education nor ability. After leaving the Liang family, you'll lose all sources of income. We'll take back your villa, your bank cards. When you're penniless, Xu Qingzhu will also divorce you. You'll really have nothing left." Qiu Zimin's voice slowed down, as if earnestly advising: "You're my daughter, how could I harm you?"

"But am I really your daughter?" Liang Shi said: "You just admitted it. I'm not."

"How are you not?" Qiu Zimin's eyes widened, reflected by the dim light behind her, looking somewhat frightening, "As long as you listen to me, you are."

"But I've done a paternity test." Liang Shi bluffed, "I'm not yours and father's daughter."

Qiu Zimin: "..."

She sneered coldly, "But I've treated you as my biological daughter all these years."

It was a risky move, but the effect was good.

Liang Shi verified her guess.

She indeed wasn't Liang Father's illegitimate child either.

Footnotes: ¹ Qi Mama: This refers to Qi Jiao's mother, who was mentioned in earlier chapters as someone who abused both Liang Shi and Qi Jiao when they were children ² Feng shui: Traditional Chinese practice of arranging physical spaces to achieve harmony with spiritual forces ³ 威: This refers to the strategy of using both kindness (恩) and 威 (威 - authority/intimidation) to control someone